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Purpose/Policy:

“This “Loading and Unloading Kegs” standard operating procedure has been created to assist operators with setup, operations, changeover, cleaning, and troubleshooting.

Scope:

When packaging product on the Racker, empty kegs of various sizes are required to fill product. Once the product has been produced and is in the kegs, the operator needs to properly stack the “Full Good Kegs” onto a pallet.

On the Racker here at MBBC, the keg line can package a variety of keg styles. Please confirm with the Lead Operator of the Rack as to which style is needed and for how many. “

Definitions/Acronyms:

- SOP – Standard Operating Procedure
- PPE – Personal Protective Equipment
- F400 – Caustic cleaning solution (Rochester Midland)
- MBBC – Mass Bay Brewing Company
- Racker – The keg line (keg washing and filling line)

Authorities/Responsibilities:

“This SOP can be completed by an entry level packaging operator after proper training from a senior member of the Keg line packaging team. The objective of this SOP is to gain the knowledge needed to perform the operation of “Loading and Unloading Kegs” and trouble shoot any issues that may arise.”

Resources and Materials:

Operations:

- Empty Kegs – Brought in by a Trained Forklift Operator.
- Nitrile Gloves.
- Lacquer thinner.
- Rags.
- Good Pallets.
- Keg Caps/Keg Cap Stickers (Corresponding to packaging run).
- Box Cutter.

Changeovers:

- N/A

Basic Cleaning:

- Broom and Dustpan.

- Trash Barrel.
- F400 Foaming Unit.

Troubleshooting:

- Inspection of empty kegs for wear, format, brand, and damage.
- For Vacuum Arm system, contact the maintenance department.

PPE Required:

- During the foaming operation in the cleaning section of this SOP document, rubber gloves, a face shield, and safety glasses must be worn.

Procedures:

Loading the Keg line with Empty Kegs:

Note: The keg line bay should be loaded with pallets of empty kegs by a trained forklift operator.

1. Determine the keg size you are running.
    1.1 Once you have determined the size, the rails on the “Empty Keg Conveyor” belt should be set “inwards” for 20L logs or “flipped” for 30/50L barrels.
2. Remove the stretch wrap from the pallet the empty kegs are on.
3. Carefully remove the kegs from the pallet and place on to the “Empty Keg Conveyor.”

Note: Inspect the keg for wear, damage, stuck on labels and any loose items that may have been left on the keg by the bar. Remove items before placing them on the belt.

4. Inspect kegs for old date coding images and if found, remove using “Lacquer Thinner” and a rag.

Pallet Storage:

1. Once the empty kegs have been placed on the “Empty Keg Conveyor” the empty pallet needs to be inspected and put away.
2. Good pallets, defined by no missing boards or damaged boards can be placed on the “Good Pallet” stack for reuse when stacking “Full Good Kegs.”
3. Bad pallets, defined by missing boards or weak boards need to be placed on the pallet recycling area located on the outside of the “Empty Keg Elevator.”
4. If pallets had been broken during the loading process, please scrab any wood into the nearest trash bin.

Unloading Full Good Kegs (20L):

1. After the kegs have been filled, inspected, weighed and date coded, it is time to stack our first “Full Good” pallet.
2. Load a “Good” pallet into the pallet load area.
3. When stacking 20L logs, we will perform this by hand. An experienced member of the Racking line team will instruct you on the proper handling of the logs and how to stack them on the pallet.
4. It is important to inspect the logs for proper date coding prior to stacking and ensure the correct keg cap/collar has been applied.
5. After a “Full Good” pallet has been finished, record the number on the corresponding check sheet and press the “Full Pallet” release button.

Unloading Full Good Kegs (30L/50L):

1. After the kegs have been filled, inspected, weighed and date coded, it is time to stack our first “Full Good” pallet.
2. Load a “Good” pallet into the pallet load area.
3. When stacking 30L/50L kegs, we will perform this by using the “Vacuum Arm” system.
4. Located on the wall closest to the office is a junction box that will turn the “Vacuum Arm” system’s air supply on or off.
5. Once the air is on, the “Vacuum Arm” can be used.
6. The “Vacuum Arm” creates suction to the bottom of the keg allowing it to be moved with ease.
7. To lower the “Vacuum Arm” push down on the inner handle and to raise, push up on the inner handle. An experienced member of the Racking line team will train on how to operate the arm and on how to stack the “Full Good” kegs on to the pallets.
8. It is important to inspect the barrels for proper date coding prior to stacking and ensure the correct keg cap/collar has been applied
9. After a “Full Good” pallet has been finished, record the number on the corresponding check sheet and press the “Full Pallet” release button.
10. When finished, press the off button on the junction box and store the “Vacuum Arm.”

Changeover Guide:

1. If switching sizes from 20L logs to 30L/50L barrels, take the keg rails and flip them outwards (away from the belts).

Basic Cleaning the load/unload area:

1. After the packaging line run has been completed, now it is time to clean.
2. Sweep the entire floor area and remove any trash or debris.

3. Using the water hose, rinse down the floor area avoiding any motors or electrical areas.
4. Using proper PPE as outlined in the “Resources and Materials” section of this SOP document, fill the F400 foamer unit up to five gallons with a mixture of hot and cold water. It should be no more than 160 degrees.
5. Carefully add 4oz of F400 per gallon of water.
6. Attach air hose to F400 Foaming unit and apply foam to the concrete floors.
7. Scrub floors with a deck brush to remove all the dirt and grime.
8. Rinse and squeegee floor once completed.

Deep Cleaning:

1. Refer to Racking Line Zone Cleaning. Zone 1 for more information.

Forms:

Not Applicable

Reference Documents:

Not Applicable

Common Issues:

1. In the event of “keg jam” inspect the belts on the “Empty Keg Conveyor” for kinks.
    1.1 Inspect rollers for damage.
    1.2 Ensure all rails are set up for the correct size.

Document History and Approval:

Revise document history as described in the table and key below.

(Reference to following document: B1C.SOP.P001: Document Control and Approval Procedure Template)

VERSION NO.	VERSION DATE	DESCRIPTION OF CHANGE	AUTHOR NAME/PROJECT MANAGER
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002	2026/10/26	Updated SOP to Newest Layout Version	Kyle Szymanski

Version Approval Number: 002

Approved by: Kyle Szymanski

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